

No. 747, February 2012

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz www.facebook.com/nzacwellington



The Hillary Ridge, Aoraki / Mt Cook
Image courtesy of Brad Nicholson

Next Section night: 13 February, 2012

Barbecue at Fergs

The first Section night of 2012 will be our traditional barbecue and climbing evening at Fergs. Come along, sign in as an NZAC member to climb for free, and enjoy one of our expertly sizzled sausages – there's even a rumour that a vegetarian sausage substitute will be available. Delish!

March Section night – short talks

The March Section night will be short talks night – details will be up on the website once talks are confirmed. If you've had an adventure or something else you'd like to talk about please email Lorraine (lj@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) and we'll get you on the programme.



Welcome to new members from Taranaki

The Wellington Section is pleased to welcome new members who come to us from the recently dissolved Taranaki Section. Thank you for joining us! We are grateful for your support and we look forward to trips, activities and events with you. In order to work well together please let us know your suggestions and ideas, and get involved. Everyone on the committee is looking forward to hearing from you.

See you soon in the hills or at an event.

Veteran 50-year members

The Wellington Section is proud to congratulate three of our members to their 50th anniversary with the NZAC:

- A Lloyd Beech
- Peter Wilson
- George Mason

Thank you for your support of the club and the Section over so many years. You are a true inspiration!

AIC 2012 – instructors wanted!

We've started to organise AIC 2012, and it's going to be a good one! If you think you'd like to instruct this year, please contact the Chief Instructor, Fraser Crichton (aic@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

All applications are welcome – we want both assistant instructors and full instructors. Instructor training and development are an important part of our preparation, and instructors are now required to have undertaken an outdoor first aid course and a basic avalanche course in order to instruct. We will fully fund our instructors to undertake these courses.

We are seeking expressions of interest early this year to make sure there is sufficient time for instructors to complete their training. Several of our instructors completed an outdoor first aid course run by MSC in December, and another course will be run in late February, so the earlier you get in touch with us, the better.

The AIC is likely to take place from late July through to the beginning of September. Contact Fraser for further information about potential dates.



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NZAC BOULDERING SERIES

NATIONAL 2012

WAKA
11TH FEBRUARY

FROGGATT EDGE
18TH FEBRUARY

TURAKIRAE HEAD
25TH FEBRUARY

SPITTLE HILL
10TH MARCH



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NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

PHOTO: CON STEWART

25th February at Turakirae Head (starting 9am)

For full NBS event info see <http://www.nbs.org.nz>

High Alpine Skills Course

Dan Pringle, with photos courtesy of Danilo Santana David

The revamped Unwin Lodge was abuzz at the New Year with good representation from Wellington. Bec Thomson, Lindsay Turner and I were all there for the second of three NZAC High Alpine Skills Courses (HASC) this summer. We bumped into John Nankervis and Kevin Paterson, and a Dave Grainger posse arrived the day we left.

Driven to a large extent by Pat Deavoll, the club's intermediate and advanced instruction courses are growing in number and reputation. I found the HASC course a perfect follow-up to the Wellington Section AIC, and thoroughly recommend it to those looking for the next level of technical skills, a summer learning environment (!) and an introduction to the mountains down south.

We had a fun, great mix of people. Our group included eight fit, engaged students from around New Zealand (and out of Australia, Brazil, England and Switzerland) and two very experienced, professional local instructors in

Sean Brooks and Andy Coles.

After flying into Barron Saddle, the course took the form of a five day journey out of the Mueller. Highlights for me were three nights' bivy-ing, climbing Sealy, and a very useful practical crevasse rescue session in the Annette plateau wind scoop. As well as excellent technical sessions, our instructors shared plenty of cautionary tales, tricks and admonitions.

Sean and Andy drove home a few key messages over and over, right through to our final wrap-up session:

1. Don't be a lazy climber. (Even when you're tired, thirsty and hungry, stay attentive to one task at a time. Keep kicking steps hard. Rope up and off when you should.)
2. Be efficient. (Ask yourself 'what can I do now to speed things up?' Some time delays are inevitable; eliminate the ones you safely can.). And most importantly:



3. Don't fucking fall in the mountains.

By the end of day five we were out for a fun night of drinks and silliness at the Chamois Pub. After a slow start and a few coffees, the final day included practical sessions on rope work, anchors, navigation, and weather.

I left with my three aims achieved: I had a fun week in the hills, feel much more confident in my technical skills, and picked up a few pearls of wisdom. Huge thanks to Pat for organising the course, to Sean and Andy – outstanding job – and to Chas and Katrina for managing a very full Unwin Lodge. Climbing is of course as

much about the 'who' as the 'what', and folks from our group are already planning our next trips together.

In addition to the NZAC climbing camp – based at Unwin while we were there – there were three HASC courses, one advanced course, a women's mountaineering course and alpine rock courses this summer. At \$1000, the HASC is incredibly good value for a fly-in 6-day course with two professional instructors. Highly recommended.

Look out for next year's schedule and book early!



Combined NZAC and Tararua Tramping Club ascent of Aspiring Tititea 4-11 November 2011

Nina Sawicki

Climbers: Rob Hawes (Trip Leader TTC and NZAC), Steve Dowall (NZAC), Nina Sawicki (NZAC and TTC), Lorraine Johns (NZAC and TTC), Richard Davison (NZAC), Stuart Hutson (NZAC), Simon Bell (NZAC), and Lisa Wynne (NZAC Australia).

Eight climbers and a melee of alpine gear and food in varying states of disarray congregated in the garage of Rob's family bach in Wanaka on Saturday 4 November. There had been some recent heavy snow fall and so after numerous cups of tea and discussion we elected to add shovels, probes and transceivers to our already heavy packs. This group of climbers chose to be purists with the intention of doing a round trip in and out from Colin Todd Hut. At Raspberry Creek we donned our heavy packs and reached Aspiring Hut about 7.00 pm after a two hour plod with fresh snow still

falling further up the valley and visible through Bevan Col. Steve had a minor trip on a slippery rock and bravely continued with a torn gastrocnemius muscle and never once did we hear him complain. Various supplies of stronger analgesics (I resisted giving him my morphine!) were passed to him throughout the trip and the muscle continued to moan but accepted the fate of its master's quest for Tititea!

In the morning we set off at 7.00 am and decided to head first to French Ridge Hut as Rob thought that the avalanche risk through Bevan Col was probably too high. After an hour and half along the valley floor the route crossed the Matukituki. No-one wanted wet boots and socks so the toes had a chilly morning freshen-up before the precipitous climb up to French Ridge Hut at about 1450 metres via Gloomy Gorge. Tears rolled down my cheek with the pack



weight, and angel Lorraine kindly produced a pink coconut ice lolly. She has become a friend for life! (After the climb I discovered a large blister on my shoulder under my pack strap!). There was still plenty of snow right up to the hut and the tussock in places was quite slippery. We arrived about 1.30 pm and elected not to push on to Colin Todd due to uncertain snow conditions across the Bonar. We had a magnificent vista of scurrying clouds and the odd snow flurry on Mts Liverpool and Barff across the valley. Two cheeky keas entertained us for the afternoon and all colourful clothing was promptly removed from the deck. A guide and his client arrived later in the afternoon having had a fright with a small avalanche on the slopes of Mt Avalanche that day (no irony intended). We later heard (through the radio-schedule) that a couple had taken 10 hours to cross the Bonar glacier that day in a white-out so were pleased with Rob's decision not to continue.

The morning dawned fine and we left at 6.00 am to head up to the Quarterdeck Pass to access the Bonar. It was a magnificent ascent up to the pass with excellent cramponing conditions and no difficulty crossing the exposed part of the ridge across the top of the gorge. We were greeted by the sight of Aspiring in perfect weather at the top of the Quarterdeck Pass at 2140 m. The Bonar glacier traverse was

straightforward and we arrived at Colin Todd Hut at about 1.00 pm. The hut was packed with a melee of guides and their clients, but some tactful negotiations with the guiding companies by Rob prior to the trip ensured we had sufficient space for us all with the one tent (of Simons's: selflessly carried)

The morning dawned wet and windy and so was a day of tea and rest. The guides in the hut had a satellite phone and some had planned a camp on top of the ramp (via the NW Ridge) in preparation for summit bid the next day while others camped at the top of the kangaroo. Later in the day Rob and Simon (who was woken from a long slumber) put in a foot path to the base of the ramp. The forecast suggested a front later for the next day so a summit bid look positive if we were back at the hut prior to its arrival. We discussed climbing tactics to minimise congestion on the ramp and we planned our climb with parties staggered, leaving on the hour from 1.00 am. I didn't sleep a wink and thought everyone else was in a peaceful slumber (It could be no further from the truth). Rob woke at 12.00 am and after a reccie on the outside freeze signalled we were all set to go. Rob and I left the hut at 12.40 and were at the base of the ramp by 2.30. The star studded sky though was long gone, which was an ominous sign. We crested the top of the ramp by





5.00 am (eight pitches) and the group camping at the top of the ramp were as startled as us. My water bladder had frozen but I managed a mouth of Whittaker's chocolate (the earliest in the morning I have ever eaten chocolate). Headlights were strewn down the ramp and the chinking of snow stakes and hammers framed this most special moment. At this point Rob and I un-roped and began our steady climb up the ridge to the summit at 3033. The ridge was frozen and there was no exposed rock so it was a very methodical rhythmic climb and I was glad of the second tool on the steeper parts.

Nearer the summit we placed some anchors for the final steep 60 m to the summit as I yelled "4/10". Rob had a very neutral system to assess the need for protection as a number out of ten. We summited at 7.48 am and had sweeping vistas before the front moved in. Rain, wind and hail welcomed us on the descent and also down the ramp. The other three teams and guides elected to pitch the ramp as the conditions had deteriorated by then with visibility and wind slowing progress. They progressively summited over the morning. It was very cold descending and the rope work and anchors a challenge with freezing hands. The biner on my daisy chain locked itself closed as well just "to make mischief". However with the lower temperatures there was only small amount of ice-fall on the ramp (mostly from climbers above) and any danger of anchors not holding on softening snow was minimal – the challenge

was releasing them from the grip of the ice. We arrived back at the hut at 2.30 pm and slowly the groups arrived one by one with great relief and smiles despite the less than ideal climbing conditions. Lorraine had managed the climb despite being sick with a cold. Endless cups of tea flowed.

The next day most of us rested but Steve, Rob and Simon climbed the Rolling Pin. The weather was spectacular with views across the Waipara Valley to Mts Athene, Eros and Ionia. The forecast indicated deteriorating weather the next day so we were away at 6.00 am and were joined by Marta and Andrew Scott (for the descent) and crossed the Bonar with ease to Bevan Col where we un-roped from glacier travel but retained our harnesses. We were able to descend through the col with relative ease as it was still snow-filled. We had but one tricky part with some steep wet slabs (minimal snow cover) and then were able to cross a stable snow bridge across the top of the waterfall (so no glissading please!) so there was no need for the rope or any abseils. After a longish break at Aspiring Hut for lunch we reached Raspberry Flat after 10 hours to hugs, the removal of smelly socks, a tasty meal (not the socks), wine and a shower.

Thanks so much to Rob for his exceptional leadership (and decision making) and all in the group who supported each other over the seven days.

Tackle the North Wall

The alpine weather has got the better of the north wall of our hut at Tukino.

So we're recladding it and we need as much help as possible. We'll consider anybody no matter what your skills are. We've got lots of jobs, ranging from painting, stuffing insulation, to fastening the cladding. It should be a fun weekend, and if we have enough people, you might be able to sneak off for a little while to scout out some of the rock climbing potential.

When: 23rd to 25th March (reserve weekend April 20-22)

Interested? Then contact Don French on 027 445 2980 or email don.f@xtra.co.nz



Wellington Section Webmaster Vacancy (volunteer role)

The Wellington Section is looking for a new webmaster. The role entails keeping the Section's website up-to-date with information relevant to members, including Section night information, upcoming trip information, Vertigo, various newsworthy items and general maintenance of the site.

See www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for the Section's website.

The website uses the Wordpress Content Management System. It's easy to learn so if you're keen to get into the world of web development and content management then this is the opportunity for you.

As well as general updating this role may occasionally involve some liaison with NZAC head office's publications convenor regarding the Club's national website strategy.

The ideal person would be someone who enjoys climbing and is keen to help keep Section members informed of the goings on of the Section.

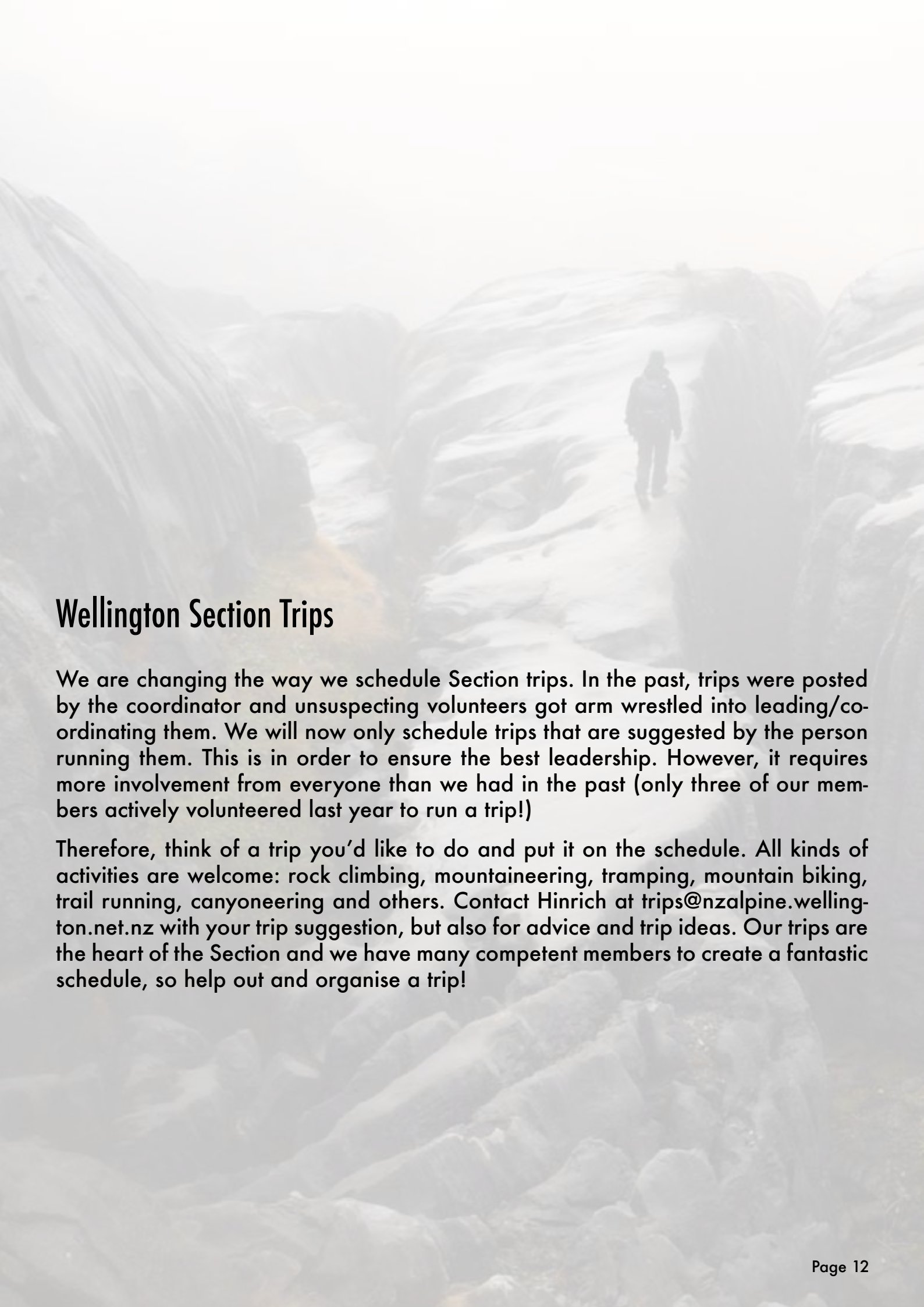
If this sounds like something you'd be interested in helping with please send an e-mail to secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

Do you own or use a Personal Locator Beacon?

On a recent trip one of the Section's Personal Locator Beacons (PLB) got activated in an emergency. The ensuing rescue operation brought to light several issues concerning the effectiveness of a PLB:

- Trigger the PLB in an area with satellite coverage (if possible). Our beacon was activated in a narrow gorge, so the beacon could not be located via its GPS by the rescue coordination. If you have the choice, bring the PLB into an open area before setting it off.
- If you own a beacon, register it with the rescue coordination centre and provide a good emergency contact.
- Leave detailed trip intentions and contact info for each participant with the emergency contact. For the Section, this is done by sending an email to an account that will be accessed by S&R in an emergency.
- For Section PLBs, read and follow the instructions carefully when signing it out.
- A PLB that has been activated must be sent back to the manufacturer. However, it will not be sent back but replaced with a new unit that has a different UIN number. You must register this new unit with S&R (for Section PLBs this is all done by the PLB warden).

We are revising our procedures for signing out the Section's PLBs to ensure maximum safety for trips. With any questions contact Hinrich at trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

A person is seen from behind, walking away on a narrow, snow-covered mountain trail. The trail is flanked by steep, rocky slopes covered in patches of snow. The person is wearing dark outdoor gear. The overall scene is misty and atmospheric, with soft lighting.

Wellington Section Trips

We are changing the way we schedule Section trips. In the past, trips were posted by the coordinator and unsuspecting volunteers got arm wrestled into leading/coordinating them. We will now only schedule trips that are suggested by the person running them. This is in order to ensure the best leadership. However, it requires more involvement from everyone than we had in the past (only three of our members actively volunteered last year to run a trip!)

Therefore, think of a trip you'd like to do and put it on the schedule. All kinds of activities are welcome: rock climbing, mountaineering, tramping, mountain biking, trail running, canyoneering and others. Contact Hinrich at trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz with your trip suggestion, but also for advice and trip ideas. Our trips are the heart of the Section and we have many competent members to create a fantastic schedule, so help out and organise a trip!

Notices

Stay at Tukino this summer

Stay at Tukino this summer at \$15 per night for NZAC members.

bookings@TukinoAlpineSportsClub.org.nz



Four day painting workshop

Four day painting workshop with renowned Christchurch artist Jane Zusters, April 13th – 16th at the new improved Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook.

This four day workshop is for both beginners and experienced painters and the focus will be on the development of each individual's painting practice through a guided encounter with the Mt Cook environment. Jane's focus is on enabling each individual's creative journey rather than adhering to any particular technique, style or genre. Through creative exercises and a focus on the physical environment, students will be encouraged to use the workshop as a launching pad to fuel their own art exploration.

Medium: Acrylics

Arrival time: Meet at Unwin Lodge at 6.00 pm April 12th for a prepared dinner at 6.30 pm.

Departure time: Around 3 pm on April 16th.

Numbers: Max 6

Cost: \$700.00

Applicants must be NZAC members. The course fee includes instruction, accommodation and

evening meals. It doesn't include transport. You will be expected to pay a \$300 deposit at the time of registration to secure your place on the course. Cancellation insurance is available.

Christchurch based Jane Zusters is an experienced art tutor who has facilitated numerous painting workshops, including classes at Artstation, Auckland University Extension Studies and Whanganui Polytechnic. Her philosophy is to make art from the life experiences that she feels passionate about. She has exhibited widely throughout New Zealand since the 70s and is in most major national public collections including Te Papa Tongarewa, the Christchurch Art Gallery and Southland Museum and Art Gallery. See www.janezusters.co.nz for further information on Jane's artwork.

The course cost includes all instruction, accommodation and evening meals on the nights of the 12th/13th/14th and 15th.

If you are interested in this course, please contact Pat Deavoll at pat@alpineclub.org.nz for a registration form and an equipment list.

Six month membership extension

The six month membership extension winner for December was Dave Kidd (Central North

Island). The winner for January is Robert Goldsmith (Overseas).

Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed

Upcoming second edition of Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed: information needed!

Information about new routes, crags and areas is now being collated for the next edition of the Queenstown Rock, Ice and Mixed. This guidebook will have a very different look to its predecessor with lots of extras. It will also comprehensively cover the iconic Mt Earnslaw and nearby peaks. If you wish to contribute and

have any info about routes (new or existing) that you have climbed around Queenstown, or if you have climbed routes on Mt Earnslaw or other peaks in the Rees, Dart or Routeburn valleys, please email us at queenstownclimbing@gmail.com.

Cheers,

Guillaume

New Member Discount - A Plus Lodge & Iwiheke Backpacker

Run by Richard Seddon's son Ian, discounted accommodation is available to FMC, NZAC, and Alpine Sports Club members. Accommodation is available for \$16 per night per person, or a family of four will pay just \$50 per room.

They have double rooms, single, share or dormitory style beds. Check out www.tongariro-hostel.co.nz

Flat wanted in Wellington

I'm seeking a fun flat to move into, preferably close to town. If having an active flatmate who is into outdoors activities but also lazy brunches sounds good to you then please get in touch!

Additional skills include fixing bikes and appliances, and belaying other people on hard pitches. Please get in touch at hooker.mark@gmail.com or on 021 481 443.

Mature Mountaineers Meetings – Speakers Needed

The NZAC hold Mature Mountaineers afternoons in the Christchurch National Office up to four times a year. The meetings are designed around members aged 65 years and over, to give them a chance to meet in the daytime and talk over past exploits with their fellow climbers.

We are desperately seeing speakers so that we can continue providing these get-togethers through 2012 (slides and images welcome). Please contact ollie@alpineclub.org.nz if you are interested. Your offer would be greatly appreciated, thank you.

Missing boots – Unwin Lodge

These boots have gone missing from the rear of Unwin Lodge, sometime from 18–21 December, 2011. They are size EU 42/43, UK 8, and still in very good nick.

If you know of their whereabouts, please contact Markus Milne 021 482 150, or Chas Tanner 03 435 1100 / 027 817 6860



Mountain Photography Course

Four day mountain photography course with renowned landscape photographer Colin Monteath.

April 13th–16th 2012 at the new improved Unwin Lodge, Aoraki Mt Cook.

Christchurch-based Colin Monteath is a world renowned polar and mountain photographer who has had 30 seasons in Antarctica and four in the Arctic. He has climbed and trekked throughout the Southern Alps since 1967 and around the world since 1974, including 21 expeditions to Himalayan countries. He has written 10 books and supplied images to many others. In 1984, after his return from the North Face of Everest, Colin set up a photo library www.hedgehoghouse.com. See also: www.colinmonteath.com

This course is aimed at keen “intermediate” digital or film photographers who want to extend their skills to produce better mountain landscape images. Course participants will have all their own camera equipment and, if shooting digitally, an ability to download files into their own portable computer.

There will be evening lectures on adventures and expedition photojournalism as well as ses-

sions to discuss techniques and raw file processing. The course aims to spend one night in Mueller Hut to take images of the sunset and dawn.

After the course, processed images will be discussed and a selection sent to The Climber and/or New Zealand Alpine Journal for publication. Images may also be submitted to NZAC’s photo competition later in the year.

Participants are expected to arrive by 6pm April 12th for a welcome dinner with the ‘painters.’ Departure will be mid-afternoon on April 16th.

Course cost: \$750 per person, which includes all instruction, accommodation and transport Chch-Mt Cook-Chch if required and evening meals on the nights of the 12th/13th/14th and 15th.

You will be required to pay a \$300 non refundable deposit to secure your place on the course. Cancellation insurance is available. Applicants must be members of the NZAC (Full info available on the NZAC website: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/news/2012/an-opportunity-not-to-be-missed-four-day-mountain-photography-workshop-with-colin-monteath>).

NZAC now on Twitter and Facebook

You can now follow the New Zealand Alpine Club’s activities on Twitter @nzalpineclub and Facebook www.facebook.com/groups/5638346254/

You can follow the Wellington Section at www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Unwin Lodge – new blog

Chas Tanner, Unwin’s new Lodge Manager has started a blog. You can access this via the hut’s

main NZAC webpage at <http://alpineclub.org.nz/hut/unwin>

Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival August 16th–19th 2012

The inaugural Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival will be held at Queenstown on 16th–19th August.

This event will bring together the top winter alpine climbers in New Zealand as a means of advancing and promoting modern mixed climbing, and will showcase the new and existing route potential on New Zealand's most accessible multipitch winter training area. Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing

partnerships will be a key aim, and all festival attendees will receive the latest guide for the Remarkables. This will have over 30 unclimbed routes and detailed information on more than 150 possible summer and winter climbs.

For further details and info on how to register, visit <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/>

<http://www.facebook.com/#!/pages/Remarkables-Ice-Mixed-Festival/130651843714800>

Mt Arrowsmith Images Request

Requesting images taken from Mt. Arrowsmith looking toward Jagged Peak with Cameron Glacier in the photo. I realise this is quite specific, but if people have such a photo, could they send me their name, the date they took the photo, and permission to use the image in scientific talks about snow avalanches, glacier

mass balance, and modelling this process. I am a PhD student at Victoria University studying some South Island glaciers. The photographer's name will be shown on the photo and in the acknowledgements in presentations. Thank you for your time. Alice Doughty (NZAC member) alice.doughty@gmail.com

Found Gear

The Homer Hut warden for December/January has dropped off a rack left at the hut to the NZAC Home of Mountaineering in Christch-

urch. If the rack is yours or you know whose it might be please get in touch with us. kester@alpineclub.org.nz

2012 Calendars

The last of the 2012 calendars are now on sale for \$10 members (\$15 non-members) – includes postage.

Purchase online while stock lasts: <https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/nzac-alpine-calendar-2012-special>

De la Beche Hut demolition

De la Beche Hut demolition is scheduled for 20th February 2012

FMC Newsletter

The December newsletter is now available on our website at www.fmc.org.nz/wp-content/uploads/Newsletter/Club1112.pdf.

Phil Glasson

Secretary, Federated Mountain Clubs

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Hinrich Schaefer	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	vacant		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
	Nina Sawicki	NS	
	Dan Pringle	DP	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Fraser Crichton		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	vacant	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



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